

ESSENTIAL

Document Checklist by Applicant Type

Employed - Self-Employed - Student - Retired - Hosted/Sponsored

Every applicant needs

- Valid passport meeting the validity and blank-page requirements
- Completed Schengen visa application form and recent photo
- Travel medical insurance certificate meeting the mandatory minimum coverage
- Proof of accommodation for every night of your stay
- Round-trip flight itinerary
- Financial evidence covering the trip (see the Financial Requirements Overview)

If you're employed

- A letter from your employer confirming your role, salary, and approved leave dates
- Recent pay slips (typically the last 3-6 months)
- Bank statements showing regular income and available balance

If you're self-employed or run a business

- Business registration documents
- Recent business and/or personal bank statements

If you're a student

- A current enrolment/study confirmation letter from your institution
- If a parent/guardian is funding the trip: their financial evidence and a letter confirming support and relationship

If you're retired

- Pension or retirement account statements

If you're being hosted or sponsored

SPONSORSHIP DECLARATIONS VARY BY COUNTRY

If someone in the Schengen area is hosting or funding you, most member states require a formal declaration in their own specific form - for example, France's attestation d'accueil or Germany's Verpflichtungserklärung. The exact name, form, and process differ by which country's consulate you're applying to - check the specific requirement for your destination before assuming a generic letter is enough. See the Cover Letter & Sponsor Templates (Complete tier) for a general-purpose starting point.